

Lyndon Baines Johnson rose to the presidency in the wake of President Kennedy's death in 1963, and was confirmed in power by a landslide election victory the following year. In office, Johnson initiated an idealistic program of domestic reforms designed to tackle poverty and racial injustice. However, mounting involvement in Vietnam and violence on the streets of American cities undermined support for his presidency—ranked, by the end, as one of the most unpopular in US history.